

of disputed issues and competing versions of a second amended complaint, leaving it to the Court to decide which version gets filed. The Court declines to proceed on that basis. Plaintiff may file plaintiff's proposed second amended complaint. Defendant will have the opportunity to challenge the sufficiency of the pleading once it is filed.

Disposition

The motion is **GRANTED**. Plaintiff shall file and serve an amended complaint no later than July 15, 2026. Defendant's time to respond shall run from service. PLAINTIFF TO PREPARE THE ORDER AFTER HEARING.

2. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01921
CASE NAME: A-S PIPELINES INC., A CALIFORNIA CORPORATION VS. GOLD COAST PIPELINES, INC. A CALIFORNIA CORPORATION
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: SEAL**
FILED BY: GOLD COAST PIPELINES, INC. A CALIFORNIA CORPORATION
TENTATIVE RULING:

Defendants Gold Coast Pipelines, Inc. and David Seeno ("Defendants") filed a Motion to Seal on February 13, 2026 (the "**2/13/26 Motion to Seal**"). The Motion to Seal was set for hearing on June 29, 2026. The motion is unopposed.

This 2/13/26 Motion to Seal seeks sealing of portions of several pleadings filed in connection with a prior discovery referee motion (the "Prior Discovery Referee Motion").

That motion was ruled upon by the Court. See Order entered March 2, 2026 (as to hearing conducted February 23, 2026 after being advanced from May 11, 2026) (the "3/2/26 Order").

This matter is one of a number of motions to seal filed along with various motions and other pleadings. In its discretion, the Court makes certain further orders herein as to the other pending motions to seal, as discussed below.

On January 6, 2026, plaintiff David T. Seeno ("Plaintiff") filed a motion to compel further responses to discovery. That same day, a companion motion to seal ("**1/6/26 Motion to Seal**") was filed Plaintiff. Both motions were given a hearing date of June 22, 2026. The 1/6/26 Motion to Seal was later continued to July 27, 2026.

On February 25, 2026, Plaintiff filed a Demurrer to the Cross-Complaint of Cross-Complainant and Defendant Albert D. Seeno, Jr. ("ADSJ"). That same day, a companion motion to seal ("**2/25/26 Motion to Seal**") was filed Plaintiff. Both motions were given a hearing date of July 27, 2026.

Background

This motion seeks to seal portions of the reply papers submitted in connection with the Prior Discovery Referee Motion (the "Portions to be Sealed"). The subject pleadings were filed on February 13, 2026 with the Portions to be Sealed redacted from the public filing.

The Court has already heard and decided the underlying motion to which the pleading relates. It does not appear that the Court ruled on the Motion to Seal as part of that ruling. See Order entered February 5, 2026. See 3/2/26 Order.

Analysis

Under the California Rules of Court, "[u]nless confidentiality is required by law, court records are presumed to be open." Rule 2.550(c) of the California Rules of Court ("CRC"). Public access to civil proceedings serves to (i) demonstrate that justice is meted out fairly, thereby promoting public confidence in such governmental proceedings; (ii) provide a means by which citizens scrutinize and check the use and possible abuse of judicial power; and (iii) enhance the truthfinding function of the proceeding. *NBC Subsidiary (KNBC-TV), Inc. v. Superior Court* (1999) 20 Cal.4th 1178, 1219.

CRC Rule 2.551(a) provides:

A record must not be filed under seal without a court order. The court must not permit a record to be filed under seal based solely on the agreement or stipulation of the parties.

See CRC Rule 2.551(a).

A court may order that a record be filed under seal only if it expressly finds facts that establish:

- (1) There exists an overriding interest that overcomes the right of public access to the record;
- (2) The overriding interest supports sealing the record;
- (3) A substantial probability exists that the overriding interest will be prejudiced if the record is not sealed;
- (4) The proposed sealing is narrowly tailored; and
- (5) No less restrictive means exist to achieve the overriding interest.

See CRC Rule 2.550(d)(1)-(5).

The law favors maximum public access to judicial proceedings and court records. *Alfaro v. Superior Court* (2020) 58 Cal.App.5th 371, 386, quoting *Pantos v. City and County of San Francisco* (1984) 151 Cal.App.3d 258, 262-63. "Judicial records are historically and presumptively open to the public and there is an important right of access which should not be closed except for **compelling** countervailing reasons." *Id.* (emphasis added).

The supporting declaration describes that the moving parties only seek to seal certain very specific portions of the subject pleadings. See Declaration of Dillon Ostlund, ¶¶2-5.

The unredacted versions of both pleadings were lodged for the Court's review. The redacted materials are represented to include confidential information that presents a risk of serious personal or other injury to the parties to this action and other third parties if disclosed publicly. *Id.* at ¶3. The Portions to be Sealed appear narrowly tailored.

Accordingly, the Court finds that there exists an overriding interest that overcomes the right of public access to the specific Portions to be Sealed. The Court further finds that this overriding interest supports sealing the Portions to be Sealed and there exists a substantial probability that the overriding interest will be prejudiced if the Portions to be Sealed are not sealed. Subject to resolution of the issue discussed below, the Court further finds that the Portions to be Sealed are narrowly tailored and that there is no less restrictive means exist to achieve the overriding interest.

Disposition

The Court finds and orders as follows:

1. The **2/13/26 Motion to Seal** is **GRANTED**. The Court orders the sealing of Portions to be Sealed

that were filed provisionally under seal.

2. In addition, the Court orders the parties to meet and confer within two weeks of notice of entry of this order regarding all other pending motions to seal, including, but not limited to, the 1/6/26 Motion to Seal and the 2/25/26 Motion to Seal. If agreeable, the parties shall promptly prepare and submit a single Stipulation and Order regarding the granting of all such motions for the Court's review and approval.
3. The Court shall issue the order after hearing.

3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-03088

CASE NAME: SHEILA WOODRUFF VS. FCA US, LLC.

***HEARING ON MOTION FOR DISCOVERY COMPEL PLAINTIFF SHEILA WOODRUFF'S DEPOSITION AND PRODUCTION OF DOCUMENTS**

FILED BY: FCA US, LLC.

TENTATIVE RULING:

Defendant FCA US LLC ("Defendant") filed a Motion to Compel Plaintiff Sheila Woodruff's Deposition and Production of Documents and Request for Monetary Sanctions on April 22, 2026 (the "Motion to Compel Deposition"). The Motion to Compel Deposition was initially set for hearing on November 9, 2026. By the Court's Order issued May 7, 2026, the motion was advanced for hearing on June 29, 2026. The motion is opposed.

Plaintiff Sheila Woodruff ("Plaintiff") filed opposition papers on June 16, 2026. The Court exercises its discretion to consider these papers.

Reply papers were filed on June 22, 2026.

Background

Plaintiff initially noticed the deposition of Plaintiff for February 26, 2025, along with certain document production requests. See Declaration of Jennah Feeley filed April 22, 2026 ("Feeley Decl."), ¶13 and **Exhibit A** thereto.

After objections were served indicating Plaintiff's unavailability and interposing various objections to the document production requests, but no action was taken until the deposition was re-noticed for February 24, 2026. See Feeley Decl., ¶¶13-5.

A new set of objections was served on March 10, 2026. Feeley Decl., ¶16 and **Exhibit E** thereto.

A Second Amended Notice of Deposition followed. Feeley Decl., ¶17 and **Exhibit F** thereto.

A further set of objections was served on March 18, 2026. Feeley Decl., ¶19 and **Exhibit H** thereto. As Plaintiff had done before, the objections asserted that the date was unavailable for their side and noted that the date had been chosen without consultation. See Feeley Decl., Plaintiff's Objections dated March 18, 2026, **Exhibit H** ("This deposition was unilaterally noticed by Defendant for a date and time on which Plaintiff and/or Plaintiff's counsel is unavailable.").

The moving party's declaration corroborates this assertion, and it appears Defendant just kept re-noticing dates of its own choosing. See Feeley Decl., ¶15 *et seq.*